SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #56 · FEAR AND THE NEWS

"The world is getting worse and worse."

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Where it often comes from

News thrives on alarm, and a steady feed of tragedy gives the impression that everything is collapsing. Older generations may say, "It was better in my day." Anxiety rises and joy and hope fade.

What Scripture teaches

Solomon wrote, "What has been will be again, and what has been done will be done again; there is nothing new under the sun," and cautioned that it is unwise to ask why the old days were better than these (Ecclesiastes 7:10). Jesus said, "In the world you will have tribulation. But take courage; I have overcome the world!" Paul wrote that "in the last days terrible times will come," so Christians are not surprised by trouble. But we are called to live with courage and hope, trusting God, who holds everything together.

> *"I have told you these things so that in Me you may have peace. In the world you will have tribulation. But take courage; I have overcome the world!"* (John 16:33).

Also see

> "What has been will be again, and what has been done will be done again; there is nothing new under the sun" (Ecclesiastes 1:9).

> "Do not say, 'Why were the old days better than these?' For it is unwise of you to ask about this" (Ecclesiastes 7:10).

> "But understand this: In the last days terrible times will come" (2 Timothy 3:1).

> "He is before all things, and in Him all things hold together" (Colossians 1:17).

Common self-statements

- Everything is falling apart.
- It is worse than ever.
- There is no good news.
- The future looks dark.
- I cannot stand to watch.
- Nothing is safe anymore.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing the world as only getting worse.
- Mind reading: Assuming the worst is typical.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling alarmed and concluding that it must be catastrophic.
- Fortune telling: Predicting more collapse.

Challenging questions

- What news sources am I taking in, and how often?
- What good is happening that I do not hear about?
- What did people in earlier generations face?

- What does Jesus promise in a troubled world?
- What helps me stay informed without being overwhelmed?
- What good can I do near me?

Truth summary

> Trouble is real, but Jesus has overcome the world. I can stay informed in moderation, notice what is good, and hold onto hope and courage.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Anxiety/Worry
- Fear
- Worldly
- Hopeless
- Peace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Anxiety/Worry/Fear

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "The world is getting worse and worse"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"The world is getting worse and worse." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What news do I take in?
- ☐ What good am I missing?
- ☐ What did earlier generations face?
- ☐ What does Jesus promise?
- ☐ How can I stay informed calmly?
- ☐ What good can I do?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Jesus has overcome the world.
- ☐ Trouble has always existed.
- ☐ God holds all things together.
- ☐ I can take courage.
- ☐ Good is also happening.
- ☐ I can limit what I take in.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ John 16:33
  "I have told you these things so that in Me you may have peace. In the world you will have tribulation. But take courage; I have overcome the world!"
- ☐ Ecclesiastes 1:9
  "What has been will be again, and what has been done will be done again; there is nothing new under the sun."
- ☐ Colossians 1:17
  "He is before all things, and in Him all things hold together."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Courage and good news: Each week, note three good things you noticed.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, John 16:33 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Jesus has overcome the world, so I can take courage.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Fear" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Set news limits. Check news at set times.
- ☐ Collect good news. Write three good things each day.
- ☐ Do one good thing. Help someone near you.
- ☐ Memorize John 16:33. Say it when you feel alarmed.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "The world is getting worse and worse": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Courage and good news
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~The world is getting worse and worse.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, the news weighs on me. Thank You that You have overcome the world. Give me courage, hope, and a heart to do good where I am. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.